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INTERIM REVISION OF
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INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BOX, FILING, CLOTH COVERED WOOD OR FIBER

This Interim Federal Specification was developed by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D.C. 20406, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Interim Federal Specification as a valid exception to Federal Specification LLL-B-650a, dated October 20, 1965.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers requirements for filing boxes.

1.2 Classification. The filing boxes shall be of the following classes and sizes, as specified (see 3.4 and 6.2):

Class 1. With hinged cover.

Size 1 - For 3x5 inch cards.
Size 2 - For 4x6 inch cards.
Size 3 - For 5x8 inch cards.

Class 2. With hinged cover and hinged drop front.

Size 1 - For 3x5 inch cards.

1.2.1 Dimensions. The dimensions of the filing boxes shall be as specified in 3.4 and table I.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

UU-B-623 - Book Cover Board.
UU-C-282 - Chipboard.
UU-P-268 - Paper, Kraft, Untreated, Wrapping.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-F-320 - Fiberboard; Corrugated and Solid, Sheet Stock (Container Grade), and Cut Shapes.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Method.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Washington.

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Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. The material shall conform to the applicable specifications specified hereinafter. When the material is not specifically specified, it shall be suitable for the intended purpose. All materials shall conform to the thickness requirements established by this specification, and shall pass the performance tests specified for the end item. (See 4.4.1)

3.1.1 Basic material. The basic materials of which the filing boxes are manufactured shall be solid fiberboard, chipboard, binders' board (book cover board), solid wood, plywood, or a combination thereof.

3.1.1.1 Solid fiberboard. The solid fiberboard shall conform to PPP-F-320; type CF; class domestic; grade optional, provided the fiberboard is not less than 0.075 inch thick.

3.1.1.2 Chipboard. The chipboard shall conform to UU-C-282, with the exception that the chipboard shall be not less than 0.075 inch thick.

3.1.1.3 Binders' board (book cover board). The binders' board shall conform to UU-B-623; thickness optional, provided it is not less than 0.075 inch thick.

3.1.2 Covering materials. The covering material shall be woven of cotton, rayon, nylon, or polyester yarns, or a combination thereof. The cloth shall have not less than 58 yarns per inch in the warp direction, and not less than 46 yarns per inch in the filling direction. The cloth shall be black in color with a synthetic resin coating embossed in a semilustrous leather grain finish (see 4.4.1.3).

3.1.3 Lining materials. The lining material shall be a white or light colored paper.

3.2 Design.

3.2.1 Class 1. The filing box shall consist of a base section and hinged lid. The inside dimension shall be as specified in 3.4, and table I. The front of the base section shall be approximately one half inch lower than the back of the base section, or the base section shall be of equal heights, provided the index cards will protrude not less than 1/4-inch above the shoulder of the base section. The base section shall have a ledge to serve as a secure stop for the lid. The lid shall overlap the base section not less than 1/4-inch and rest evenly and squarely on the ledge of the base section, when tested as specified in 4.4.1.2. The lid shall form a flush outside surface with the base section. The lid shall open 180 degrees. The box interior shall be fully lined with lining material, as specified in 3.1.3, unless the basic material has a white or light colored lining in which case the interior of the box need not to be lined with lining paper.

3.2.2 Class 2. The design of class 2 filing box shall be as specified in 3.2.1, except that the base section shall have a hinged drop front. The drop front shall be securely hinged to the lower portion of a stationary front section of the base section. The stationary front shall be not less than 3/4-inch high and not more than 2-inches. The front drop shall open 180 degrees. In closed position, the lid shall overlap the upper portion of the drop front and form a flush outside surface.

3.3 Construction (classes 1 and 2). Class 1 and 2 filing boxes shall be made of material as specified in 3.1, and shall be of the design as specified in 3.2. The material, design, and construction shall assure that the box shall not break or crack, and the corners shall not tear, when tested as specified in 4.4.1.1. The sides, front and back of the base section shall be not less than 0.15 inch thick, except at the shoulder. The shoulder and the bottom of the base section, and the lid shall be not less than 0.075 inch thick. All corners shall be reinforced with one inch width tape securely cemented to the corners, or shall be reinforced by staples. The cloth tape reinforcing shall cover the entire corner and shall extend a minimum of 3/8-inch on each side of the corners and a minimum of 1/4-inch over the edges and into the inside of the box. Staple reinforcements, when used in lieu of cloth tape, shall extend a minimum of 3/8-inch on each side of the corners. The lid for class 1 and 2, and the drop front of class 2 box shall be

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fully hinged with one inch width cloth tape, inside and outside. The exterior of the base section and lid shall be neatly covered with covering material as specified in 3.1.2. The covering material shall uniformly extend a minimum of 1/4-inch into the inside of the base section and lid, and shall be continuous over the outside tape hinge(s) to provide additional hinge strength. The box interior shall be lined with smooth and neatly applied lining material conforming to 3.1.3, when required.

3.4 Dimensions. The inside dimension for classes 1 and 2 boxes shall be as specified in table I

TABLE I. Inside dimension of boxes (in inches)

Class	Size	Index card size	Height		Width		Depth	
			Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.
1	1	3 x 5	3-3/8	4	5-1/8	5-3/4	2-5/8	4
1	1	3 x 5	3-3/8	4	5-1/8	5-3/4	2-5/8	7
1	2	4 x 6	4-3/8	5	6-1/8	6-3/4	2-5/8	4
1	3	5 x 8	5-3/8	6	8-1/8	8-3/4	2-5/8	4
2	1	3 x 5	3-3/8	4	5-1/8	5-3/4	5-7/8	7

3.5 Identification marking. Each filing box shall be permanently and legibly marked with the name or trademark of the manufacturer.

3.6 Workmanship. The filing box shall be free from defects and imperfections which may adversely affect their appearance or serviceability. The covering and lining material shall be neatly cemented to present a smooth and uniform appearance. The occurance of defects shall not exceed the applicable quality level.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Inspection and testing of base material. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that base material is manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with this specification or referenced subsidiary specifications, standards and other documents.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Size of lot. All filing boxes of the same class and size presented for inspection at one time shall be considered a lot for purpose of examination and tests.

4.2.2 Sampling for examinations and tests. Sampling for examinations and tests shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise specified.

4.2.3 Sampling for visual and dimensional examinations. A random sample of filing boxes shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A sample unit shall be one box. The box shall be examined for defects listed in table II. The Inspection Level shall be S-3, and the Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) shall be 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.4 Sampling for preparation for delivery examination. Sampling shipping containers shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the inspection lot fully prepared for delivery. Defects of closure listed in table III shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The inspection level shall be S-2, and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

4.2.5 Sampling for end-item tests. For each test, random sample of filing boxes shall be selected from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105. The boxes shall be tested as specified in 4.4.1, 4.4.1.1 and 4.4.1.2. The Inspection Level shall be S-2, and the AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.6 Sampling for covering material tests. One filing box shall be taken at random from each lot. Covering material shall be detached from the base section and lid and tested as specified in 4.4.1 and 4.4.1.3.

4.3 Examination.

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4.3.1 Visual and dimensional examination. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined for defects listed in table II. Any filing box having one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective units in the sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the entire lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE II. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Class	Not of the class specified (see 1.2 and 3.4).
Material	Material not as specified (see 3.1).
Design	Design not as specified in 3.2.1 and 3.2.2, as applicable.
Construction	Construction not in accordance with 3.3.
Dimensions	Dimension not as specified in 3.4 and Table I.
Identification marking	Identification marking missing, incomplete, or illegible (see 3.5).
Workmanship	Workmanship not in accordance with 3.6.

4.3.2 Examination for preparation for delivery. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be examined for defects listed in table III to determine whether packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Any shipping container having one or more defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective boxes exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE III. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location sequence or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or not as specified. Any component damaged, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as, incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, improper taping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of containers.

4.4 Test.

4.4.1 End item test. Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.5 shall be subjected to the following tests. Any filing box in the sample failing one or more tests shall be considered defective. If the number of defective boxes exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4.1.1 Construction strength test. Apply a 20 pound force to the inside surface of one side of the lower portion of the box in the direction perpendicular to the surface. The force shall be uniformly distributed over an area one inch square located at the top edge 1-1/2 inches from the back corner. The load shall be gradually applied over a period of not less than five seconds and shall be maintained at 20 pounds for a period of five minutes. The box shall be maintained in position by an opposing pressure against the inside surface directly opposite the surface of which the force is applied. The restraining pressure shall be uniformly distributed over an area one inch square located at the top edge one inch from the back corner. This test shall assure compliance with the requirements specified in 3.3

4.4.1.2 Slipping test. A ten pound weight shall be gradually place on the top of a closed filing box for a period of ten minutes. The weight shall be large enough to cover the entire top surface of the lid. The test shall assure that the lid will not slip over the ledge of the base section. (See 3.2)

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4.4.1.3 Covering material test. The sample covering material shall be subjected to the test cited in table IV to verify yarns per inch requirements stated in 3.1.2. Two determinations shall be made on the sample material. When requested, the supplier shall submit a certificate of compliance stating that the covering material has been manufactured of yarn(s), as specified in 3.1.2.

TABLE IV. Physical properties testing

Physical properties	Fed. Test Method STD. No. 191
Yarns per inch in woven cloth	Test Method No. 5050

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A or B. Each filing box shall be wrapped with paper conforming to UU-P-268 and secured with tape.

5.1.2 Level C. The boxes shall be packed in accordance with the supplier's commercial practices.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Filing boxes of one class and size only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in the most compact manner in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style RSC, V3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed, waterproofed with a case liner of tape, and reinforced with flat steel strapping or tape banding, in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. The weight of contents shall not exceed 65 pounds.

5.2.2 Level B. Twenty-four filing boxes of like description, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The filing boxes shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination, at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies, in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2. Marking.

5.2.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.2.2 Military agencies. In addition to marking required by the contract or order, the shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The filing boxes are intended to be used as a file box for the maintenance of Index cards or forms printed on card stock.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the perferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) Class, size, index card size, and depth of filing card box required (see 1.2 and 1.2.1).

(c) Inspection responsibility, if other than as specified herein (see 4.1).

(d) Applicable levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

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